

Python for Data Science ¶

Python

- Multi-platform
- Interpreted / Dynamic Typing
- Garbage Collected
- Object-Oriented & Procedural
- **Large Standard Library**

Created by [Guido van Rossum](https://www.linkedin.com/in/guido-van-rossum-4a0756/) (<https://www.linkedin.com/in/guido-van-rossum-4a0756/>), first released in **1991**

REPL

Read, Eval, Print, Loop.

Open your terminal and launch:

```
ipython
```

Documentation

👉 [The Python 3.12 Standard Library \(https://docs.python.org/3.12/library/index.html\)](https://docs.python.org/3.12/library/index.html)

Built-in Types

Let's look at the important sections of the [documentation](https://docs.python.org/3.12/library/stdtypes.html) (<https://docs.python.org/3.12/library/stdtypes.html>) and explore the **simple** built-in types.

Numeric Types 🔗
(<https://docs.python.org/3.12/library/stdtypes.html#numeric-types-int-float-complex>)

```
In [ ]: type(42)
```

```
Out[ ]: int
```

```
In [ ]: type(3.14)
```

```
Out[ ]: float
```

```
In [ ]: 4 + 9.5
```

```
Out[ ]: 13.5
```

```
In [ ]: abs(-5)
```

```
Out[ ]: 5
```

Booleans (<https://docs.python.org/3.12/library/stdtypes.html#truth-value-testing>)

```
In [ ]: type(True) # or type(False)
```

```
Out[ ]: bool
```

```
In [ ]: True and False
```

```
Out[ ]: False
```

```
In [ ]: True or False
```

```
Out[ ]: True
```

```
In [ ]: not True
```

```
Out[ ]: False
```

What are falsy values in Python?

- Constants defined to be false: `None` and `False`
- Zero of any numeric type: `0`, `0.0`, etc.
- Empty sequences and collections: `''`, `()`, `[]`, `{}`, `set()`, `range(0)`

Comparisons

```
In [ ]: 5 < 3 # Strictly less than
```

```
Out[ ]: False
```

```
In [ ]: 4 <= 4 # Less than or equal
```

```
Out[ ]: True
```

```
In [ ]: "boris" == "seb" # equal, note the `double` =
```

```
Out[ ]: False
```

```
In [ ]: "boris" != "seb" # not equal
```

```
Out[ ]: True
```

Text Sequence Type (Strings, `str`)

```
In [ ]: "boris"
```

```
Out[ ]: 'boris'
```

```
In [ ]: "boris".capitalize()
```

```
Out[ ]: 'Boris'
```

```
In [ ]: "  boris ".strip()
```

```
Out[ ]: 'boris'
```

```
In [ ]: type(int("42"))
```

```
Out[ ]: int
```

Check out the [documentation \(https://docs.python.org/3.12/library/stdtypes.html#string-methods\)](https://docs.python.org/3.12/library/stdtypes.html#string-methods) for more `str` methods.

Advanced built-in types

Sequence Types

- [list](https://docs.python.org/3.12/library/stdtypes.html#list) (<https://docs.python.org/3.12/library/stdtypes.html#list>)
- [tuple](https://docs.python.org/3.12/library/stdtypes.html#tuple) (<https://docs.python.org/3.12/library/stdtypes.html#tuple>)
- [range](https://docs.python.org/3.12/library/stdtypes.html#range) (<https://docs.python.org/3.12/library/stdtypes.html#range>)

An example of `list`

```
In [ ]: ["apple", "cherries", "banana"]
```

```
Out[ ]: ['apple', 'cherries', 'banana']
```

```
In [ ]: len(["apple", "cherries", "banana"])
```

```
Out[ ]: 3
```

```
In [ ]: "banana" in ["apple", "cherries", "banana"]
```

```
Out[ ]: True
```

Mapping Type

There is just one in Python, dict (read "dictionary").

```
In [ ]: {'city': 'Paris', 'population': 2_141_000}
```

```
Out[ ]: {'city': 'Paris', 'population': 2141000}
```

```
In [ ]: len({'city': 'Paris', 'population': 2_141_000})
```

```
Out[ ]: 2
```

```
In [ ]: 'city' in {'city': 'Paris', 'population': 2_141_000}
```

```
Out[ ]: True
```

Variables

```
In [ ]: name = 'John' # Assignment  
print(name)
```

John

```
In [ ]: name = 'Paul' # Re-assignment  
print(name)
```

Paul

```
In [ ]: first_name = 'John'  
last_name = 'Lennon'
```

```
In [ ]: full_name = first_name + last_name  
print(full_name)
```

JohnLennon

String Formatting - Interpolation

```
In [ ]: sentence = f'Hi, my name is {first_name} {last_name}'  
print(sentence)
```

Hi, my name is John Lennon

list operations

```
In [ ]: # Indexes:      0      1      2  
beatles = ['john', 'paul', 'ringo']
```

```
In [ ]: beatles[0] # Read
```

```
Out[ ]: 'john'
```

```
In [ ]: beatles.append('george') # Create (in place)
print(beatles)
```

```
['john', 'paul', 'ringo', 'george']
```

```
In [ ]: beatles[1] = 'Paul' # Update (in place)
print(beatles)
```

```
['john', 'Paul', 'ringo', 'george']
```

Other list operations

```
In [ ]: beatles
```

```
Out[ ]: ['john', 'Paul', 'ringo', 'george']
```

```
In [ ]: beatles[1:3] # Slice of 1 to 3 (excluded)
```

```
Out[ ]: ['Paul', 'ringo']
```

```
In [ ]: del beatles[1] # Delete (in place)
print(beatles)
```

```
['john', 'ringo', 'george']
```

dict operations

```
In [ ]: instruments = {'john': 'guitar', 'paul': 'bass'} # Keys are `str`,
Values too
```

```
In [ ]: instruments['john'] # Read
```

```
Out[ ]: 'guitar'
```

```
In [ ]: instruments['ringo'] = 'drums' # Create / Update
print(instruments)
```

```
{'john': 'guitar', 'paul': 'bass', 'ringo': 'drums'}
```

```
In [ ]: del instruments['john']
instruments
```

```
Out[ ]: {'paul': 'bass', 'ringo': 'drums'}
```

Other dict operation

```
In [ ]: instruments
```

```
Out[ ]: {'paul': 'bass', 'ringo': 'drums'}
```

What will happen if we run `instruments['john']` ?

```
In [ ]: instruments['john']
```

```
-----  
-----  
KeyError                                Traceback (most recent ca  
ll last)  
<ipython-input-40-4f6ae9ee253b> in <module>  
----> 1 instruments['john']  
  
KeyError: 'john'
```

```
In [ ]: instruments.get('john', 'Default instrument')
```

```
Out[ ]: 'Default instrument'
```

Control Flow

Once again, the documentation is very [thorough](https://docs.python.org/3.12/tutorial/controlflow.html) (<https://docs.python.org/3.12/tutorial/controlflow.html>).

if statement

```
In [ ]: age = int(input("How old are you?"))  
  
if age >= 21:  
    print("You can become president")  
elif age >= 18:  
    print("You can vote")  
else:  
    print("Be patient!")
```

for statement (on a list)

```
In [ ]: words = ['cat', 'wolf', 'beetle']  
for word in words:  
    print(word.upper())
```

```
CAT  
WOLF  
BEETLE
```

List comprehension

You can achieve the same result in just one line:

```
In [ ]: [print(word.upper()) for word in words]
```

... or store it in a new variable:

```
In [ ]: uppercase_words = [word.upper() for word in words]
print(uppercase_words)

['CAT', 'WOLF', 'BEETLE']
```

What if you need the index inside the `for` loop?

```
In [ ]: for index, word in enumerate(words):
        print(index, word)

0 cat
1 wolf
2 beetle
```

for statement (on a dict)

```
In [ ]: instruments
```

```
Out[ ]: {'paul': 'bass', 'ringo': 'drums'}
```

```
In [ ]: for beatle, instrument in instruments.items():
        print(f'{beatle.capitalize()} plays the {instrument}')

Paul plays the bass
Ringo plays the drums
```

while loop

```
In [ ]: i = 1
while i <= 4:
    print(i)
    i = i + 1
```

```
1
2
3
4
```

Functions

Let's see how we can [define and use our own functions](#)

(<https://docs.python.org/3.12/tutorial/controlflow.html#defining-functions>).

```
In [ ]: def is_even(number):  
        return number % 2 == 0
```

- The function is named `is_even`
- The function takes **1** parameter: `number`
- The function returns a `bool`

```
In [ ]: result = is_even(42)  
        print(result)
```

True

- We called the function with the **argument** `42` .
- The returned value is stored in a `result` variable.

Keyword Arguments

Let's have a look at `pandas.DataFrame.from_dict` (https://pandas.pydata.org/pandas-docs/stable/reference/api/pandas.DataFrame.from_dict.html) (Source (<https://github.com/pandas-dev/pandas/blob/v1.0.3/pandas/core/frame.py#L1168-L1247>)). Some arguments are passed with the syntax `parameter=value` .

```
In [ ]: def is_odd(number=0):  
        return number % 2 == 1
```

```
In [ ]: result = is_odd(number=1)  
        print(result)
```

True

Mixing positional and keyword arguments

```
In [ ]: def full_name(first_name, last_name, capitalize=False):  
        if capitalize:  
            return f"{first_name.capitalize()} {last_name.capitalize()}"  
        else:  
            return f"{first_name} {last_name}"
```



```
In [ ]: print(full_name("john", "lennon"))
        print(full_name("ringo", "starr", capitalize=True))

john lennon
Ringo Starr
```

Modules

(<https://docs.python.org/3.12/tutorial/modules.html>)

As our programs grow longer, we'll want to split the code into multiple files and folders.

Here is a very simple example to illustrate this technique:

```
mkdir project && cd project
touch app.py
mkdir helpers && touch helpers/__init__.py
```

```
In [ ]: # helpers/__init__.py
import random
import string

def generate_password(size):
    """Generate a random lowercase ASCII password of given size"""
    letters = string.ascii_lowercase
    return ''.join(random.choice(letters) for i in range(size))
```

```
In [ ]: # app.py
from helpers import generate_password # Module import here

print(generate_password(16))
```

```
python app.py
```

Before you go, one more thing!

Debugging

- `print(your_variable)`
- `ipython`
- `python <file_name>`

When running your code with `python <file_name>` you can use the [IPython debugger \(ipdb\)](https://ipython.readthedocs.io/en/stable/) (<https://ipython.readthedocs.io/en/stable/>) thanks to the built-in `breakpoint()` (<https://docs.python.org/3.12/library/functions.html#breakpoint>) function.

It will let you investigate the current state of your code.

Let's try with our `generate_password` function!

Add the debugger in the function definition and run `python app.py` file from the Terminal.

```
In [ ]: # helpers/__init__.py
import random
import string

def generate_password(size, upper=False):
    """Generate a random lowercase ASCII password of given size"""
    letters = string.ascii_uppercase if upper else string.ascii_low
    ercase
    breakpoint() # <- That's a BREAKPOINT!
    return ''.join(random.choice(letters) for i in range(size))
```

You can access the `args`, variables defined within the function (`letters`) and much more: just type the name of the variable and hit ENTER.

To see the part of the code you're at, type `list` (or just `l`).

To continue the execution try:

- `next` (or just `n`) - execute the current line and go to the next line
- `step` (or just `s`) - step into the next function that will be called
- `continue` (or just `c`) - continue until the next `breakpoint()`, or the end

If you want to see all available commands type `help` (or just `h`).

Tips from TAs

Read the instructions!

It's OK not to finish all challenges

Pseudocode first!

Programming is all about going step by step, decomposing hard problems into small ones.

 Write down the steps you'll need to code in plain English.

Separate 🤔 thinking about the ⚙️ logic from getting the `["syntax' ) }` exactly right.

Run your code!

!! Don't try to make directly.

```
# example.py
def my_function(param1, param2):
    # BODY
    # BODY
    # BODY
    return # SOMETHING

print(my_function(arg1, arg2)) # <- Temp code to test! Remove before final commit/push
```

and then run the code in your terminal:

```
python example.py
```

Debug your code!

Poor man's way: `print()` all the things! What's the type of this variable? What does it contain at this point of the program?

Better: debug your code using `breakpoint()` !

💪 **Debugging** is one of the most important skills to master in your career!

Advanced Language Topics

To master Python, here are some additional topics to dive into during the Bootcamp:

- [List Comprehensions](https://treyhunner.com/2015/12/python-list-comprehensions-now-in-color/) (<https://treyhunner.com/2015/12/python-list-comprehensions-now-in-color/>).
- [Iterators & Generators](https://anandology.com/python-practice-book/iterators.html) (<https://anandology.com/python-practice-book/iterators.html>).
- [Object Oriented Programming](https://anandology.com/python-practice-book/object_oriented_programming.html) (https://anandology.com/python-practice-book/object_oriented_programming.html).
- [*args & **kwargs](https://www.digitalocean.com/community/tutorials/how-to-use-args-and-kwargs-in-python-3) (<https://www.digitalocean.com/community/tutorials/how-to-use-args-and-kwargs-in-python-3>).
- [Memory Management / Garbage Collection](https://docs.python.org/3.12/faq/design.html?highlight=gabage%20collector#how-does-python-manage-memory) (<https://docs.python.org/3.12/faq/design.html?highlight=gabage%20collector#how-does-python-manage-memory>).

Your turn!

Head to Kitt, find your **buddy** and start your first challenge!

Remember:

- Read the assignment **carefully**
- Run your code with `python <file.py>` before running `make`
- Talk with your buddy
- Raise a **ticket** 🙋

Have fun! 🚀